

Kodak EasyShare Z740

Bigger And Stronger, But Better?

Kodak has recently launched the EasyShare Z740 kit comprising a five-megapixel auto-focus CCD camera with 10X optical and 5X digital zoom, and a printer dock.

At a glance, the Z740 is shaped very similar to its predecessor, the DX7590, but the body is of silver-grey plastic, unlike the metal body of the DX7590, which makes the latter heavier and therefore, steadier. The Z740 boots really fast—in just three seconds.

The camera can take photos at up to 2579 x 1932 pixels. Video recording is supported at 640 x 480 or 320 x 240 in QuickTime MOV format. Onboard memory is 32 MB, which is not enough if you take the camera on a trip, but this is expandable via SD and MMC card slots.

Various settings such as Picture/Video size, White Balance, Focus Zone, Auto Focus control, etc. can be adjusted. A jog dial facilitates access to various functions such as Video and Macro. The 'Share' button allows you to



Company **Kodak India Ltd (Available from Neoteric)**

Price **Rs 24,990**

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Rating 

activate the EasyShare feature when connected to a PictBridge-ready printer. The 1.8-inch colour LCD is difficult to view outdoors, and the display quality is not so great.

The photos we took reproduced colours naturally, but the auto-focus leaves much to be desired as many of the photos seemed to lose out on sharpness. Also, the image brightness reduces as magnification is increased.

The Z740 comes with a Printer Dock Series 3 that is used for PC-less printing of borderless photos up to 4 x 6 inches. It is bundled with a printer dock and priced at Rs 24,990.

Motorola A780

A Power-packed Performer

Motorola's A780 is a Linux-based flip-phone and includes every feature you can think of (except radio and Wi-Fi), and then some more.

It is powered by a 312 MHz processor—hence the slightly sluggish interface. It has the usual features such as GPRS and Bluetooth, and applications including the Opera Web browser and even RealPlayer. It comes with a 128 MB Transmeta flash card, which gives you some space over the 50 MB onboard. Motorola also added a 1.3-megapixel camera with 8X digital zoom.

Being a PDA-phone, it features a touch-screen and allows multiple input formats and also a regular cell phone keypad on the flip lid. Another cool feature is the voice recognition. Turning it On will allow you to simply speak names or numbers, and the phone will try to understand what you're saying.

A jog dial on the left can be pressed or moved up and down to adjust volume but the menus it generates are contextual. All-in-all, a decent PDA-phone, which doesn't compromise on build or aesthetics.



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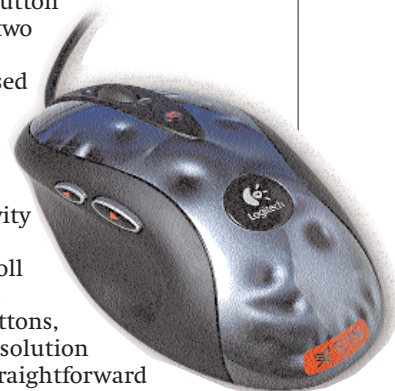
Logitech MX518 Gaming-grade Optical Mouse

With increasing skill levels and cut-throat competition, any advantage you have while fragging fellow gamers is welcome. This is exactly what the new Logitech MX 518 does. For the first time, you can change your mouse resolution on-the-fly!

This is an eight-button optical mouse with two buttons near your thumb, which are used for moving back and forth in Web pages. You need to be careful with these buttons—the sensitivity is very high.

The clickable scroll wheel is sandwiched between two tiny buttons, which control the resolution changer. There's a straightforward '+' and '-' signifying increase and decrease in resolution. The mouse supports three resolutions: 400, 800 and 1600 dpi.

A software disk has been provided, but we had some issues installing it and making it work. The mouse does a neat job, is comfortable to hold, and the resolution switching is indeed a godsend!



Company **Logitech Electronics India**

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Rating 

1 Poor: Has serious drawbacks and needs improvement before it can be used for its target application. **2 Mediocre:** Does not live up to expectations, needs improvement in many areas. **3 Average:** Reasonably competent, but nothing spectacular about the product. **4 Good:** A good buy, better than most products in its category. **5 Excellent:** A brilliant combination of price, performance and features—far beyond expectations.